

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DFCS

Date: 5/12/2026

Bill Number: SB41

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): Public Schools: Mental Health Education

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ **SIGN** ☐ **VETO** ☐ **LWOS**

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

Alaskan youth have very high rates of mental illness and suicide. Offering a mental health curriculum in schools will provide for a stronger overall health curriculum that may lead to a reduction in the rates of suicide and mental illness. DFCS supports efforts to increase the number of mental health resources for youth.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

SB41 directs local school boards to work with school faculty and parents to develop a policy that would provide parents notification at least two weeks before any class or program that provides instruction in mental health. This bill furthers modifies AS 14.30.360 to include mental health curricula in their current health education programs. The State Board of Education would be required to establish guidelines surrounding these curricula with consultation with the Department of Health, the Department of Family and Community Services, regional tribal health

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organizations, and representatives of national and state mental health organizations. The Department of Family and Community Services would be required when called upon to provide technical assistance to school districts in developing the curricula mentioned previously. Lastly this bill requires that the Board of Education and Early Development submit a report to the legislature that includes a copy of the guidelines developed, and describing the process the Board used to develop the guidelines.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1

Amends the uncodified law of the State of Alaska by adding Legislative intent that the development of the guidelines described in this bill be the result of collaboration between the Board of Education and Early Development, the Department of Health, the Department of Family and Community Services, regional tribal health organizations, and representatives of national and state mental health organizations.

Section 4

Amends AS 14.30.360(b) by requiring the State Board of Education to establish guidelines surrounding developmentally appropriate instruction in mental health. The Board is required to work with the Department of Health, the Department of Family and Community Services, regional tribal health organizations, and representatives of national and state mental health organizations. This section further requires the Department of Family and Community Services to work alongside various partners to provide technical assistance to school districts as they develop their mental health curricula.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

HB105

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Support: Ann Ringstad, Executive Director, National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI), Anchorage; (907) 931-9932 (NAMI main line), ann.ringstad@namialaska.org

• Nan Voorhees, parent of two children in elementary school, social worker; (907) 727-8184;

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nanvoorhees21@gmail.com

- Kelly Lessens, Anchorage School Board; (907) 742-1101, ext. 2, lessens_kelly@asdk12.org
- Michael Carson, V.P. & Recovery Specialist, MY House of Mat-Su, and Chair of the Mat-Su Opioid & Youth Task Force; (907) 373-4357 (MY House main line)
- Trevor Storrs, President & CEO, and Jen Griffis, Vice President, Policy & Advocacy, Alaska Children's Trust; (907) 248-7676, kidsfirst@alaskachildrenstrust.org
- Greg Hobson, Physical Education Teacher, Polaris K-12; hobson_gregory@asdk12.org
- Kenneth Holbrook, parent of two children at Machetanz Elementary, Wasilla; (907) 687-0776
- Angela Kimball, Chief Advocacy Officer, Inseparable; info@inseparable.us
- Diane DeSloover, Elementary School Teacher, Retired, Juneau; dianedesloover@yahoo.com
- Jonni Myers, Vice President, Kodiak College Student Government
- James Biela, American Foundation for Suicide Prevention,
Oppose: • Steven Pearce, Director, and Kathleen Wedemeyer, Deputy Director, Citizens Commission on Human Rights; (206) 755-5230 (Main line), cchrseattle@outlook.com

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

Click or tap here to enter text.

Commissioner's Signature: Thay A. Dompeling **Date:** 5/13/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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